

English, Grade 11

Workplace Preparation

ENG3E

This course emphasizes the development of literacy, communication, and critical and creative thinking skills necessary for success in the workplace and in daily life. Students will study the content, form, and style of a variety of contemporary informational, graphic, and literary texts; and create oral, written, and media texts in a variety of forms for practical purposes. An important focus will be on using language clearly and accurately in a variety of formal and informal contexts. The course is intended to prepare students for the compulsory Grade 12 workplace preparation course.

Prerequisite: English, Grade 10, Applied

Key to Footnote References

The footnotes throughout this course contain abbreviated references to teacher resource guides in the ministry's "Think Literacy Library", available on the ministry website, at www.edu.gov.on.ca. The guides are identified as follows:

- TLCC 7-12 refers to the main guide, *Think Literacy: Cross-Curricular Approaches, Grades 7-12*.
- TLE 7-9 and TLE 10-12 refer to the subject-specific guides for Language/English, Grades 7-9, and English, Grades 10-12.
- Other subject-specific guides are identified by the initials "TL", followed by the name of the subject (e.g., Computer Integration; Library Research; Media; Technological Education) and the grades the resource guide covers (e.g., TL Computer Integration 7-12).

ORAL COMMUNICATION

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- 1. Listening to Understand:** listen in order to understand and respond appropriately in a variety of situations for a variety of purposes;
- 2. Speaking to Communicate:** use speaking skills and strategies appropriately to communicate with different audiences for a variety of purposes;
- 3. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as listeners and speakers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful in oral communication situations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

1. Listening to Understand

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose

- 1.1** identify the purpose of several different listening tasks and set goals for specific tasks (*e.g., listen to the ideas of others in order to clarify their own opinion;¹ ask questions appropriately during discussions to acquire new knowledge; listen to a customer's complaints in a role play in order to be able to respond appropriately; listen to a presentation about a co-op placement in order to understand what would be expected of them during the placement*)

Teacher prompts: "How does the way you listen to music on the radio differ from the way you listen at a concert?" "What factors might interfere with your ability to listen to or understand a customer's request or question?"

Using Active Listening Strategies

- 1.2** identify and use several different active listening strategies when participating in a variety of classroom interactions (*e.g., respond to a speaker's opinion while showing respect for diversity of ideas, language, and culture;² demonstrate understanding of when to speak, when to listen, and how much to say; use verbal or non-verbal responses to indicate interest or an opinion³*)

Teacher prompts: "What can you do to let a speaker know you are listening attentively and are ready to respond?" "How can you

make sure that you understand someone who does not speak English well?"

Using Listening Comprehension Strategies

- 1.3** identify and use several different listening comprehension strategies before, during, and after listening to understand both simple and complex oral texts (*e.g., skim an article before a teacher read-aloud; make jot notes using a graphic organizer;⁴ use a summary chart to record a discussion;⁵ use teacher-and-student-generated headings to organize note-taking; use appropriate strategies when recording instructions or directions*)

Teacher prompt: "Before you listened to the presentation, you wrote down and talked about what you already knew about the topic. How did that help you to understand the presentation?"

Demonstrating Understanding of Content

- 1.4** identify the important information and ideas in both simple and complex oral texts in several different ways (*e.g., compile a list of strategies for success after listening to three motivational speakers; paraphrase a character's speech from a dramatic presentation; summarize a speech after comparing their jot notes with those of a partner⁶*)

Teacher prompt: "What was the main message in the speech? What examples did the speaker give to support that idea?"

1. TLCC 7-12 "Group Roles" 158, "Discussion Etiquette" 176 2. TL ESL/ELD Part I "Inside/Outside Circle" 16 3. TLCC 7-12 "Discussion Etiquette" 176 4. TLE 10-12 "Place Mat" 106 5. TLE 10-12 "PMI (Plus, Minus, Interesting)" 116 6. TLCC 7-12 "Determining Key Ideas" 166

Interpreting Texts

- 1.5** develop and explain interpretations of both simple and complex oral texts, using evidence from the text and the oral and visual cues used in it to support their interpretations (*e.g., compare live recordings of songs with studio versions to determine the strengths and weaknesses of each format; select or create a visual to accompany a monologue*)

Teacher prompt: “What audio and visual cues in the text might explain differences in interpretation among your classmates?”

Extending Understanding of Texts

- 1.6** extend understanding of both simple and complex oral texts by making connections between the ideas in them and personal knowledge, experience, and insights; other texts; and the world around them (*e.g., listen to a classmate’s presentation about a co-op placement and then share their own co-op experience; respond in role as a character from an oral text while being interviewed by another student; compare and contrast their own and their classmates’ reactions to a celebrity interview on a television talk show*)

Teacher prompt: “What aspects of this presentation will help you to prepare for your own? What specific techniques from this presentation will you use in your own?”

Analysing Texts

- 1.7** analyse both simple and complex oral texts, focusing on the ways in which they communicate information, ideas, issues, and themes and influence the listener’s/viewer’s response (*e.g., examine and compare the strategies that candidates running for school council use in their speeches to promote themselves; examine the techniques used in radio infomercials to entertain and inform*⁷)

Teacher prompts: “What did the candidate say to convert her critics? How did she say it? What gestures did she use while speaking? How did these gestures support and advance her message?” “How might the gesture be adjusted to deliver a different message?”

Critical Literacy

- 1.8** identify the perspectives and/or biases evident in both simple and complex oral texts and comment on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (*e.g., compare the use of stereotypes in two comedy routines; compare recordings of the same song by a male and a female artist*)

Teacher prompts: “How do these comedians use stereotypes to appeal to their target audience? How would the routines have to change to present fairer and more equitable gender representations?” “How does meaning change with the gender of the singer?”

Understanding Presentation Strategies

- 1.9** explain how several different presentation strategies are used in oral texts to inform, persuade, or entertain (*e.g., listen to the opening music of several different news programs to identify and compare the ways in which they appeal to a specific audience; critique a mock job interview to identify effective and ineffective verbal and non-verbal language*)

Teacher prompt: “What does each theme song convey about the contents of the news program that follows? What differences can you note between the two theme songs in terms of pace, repetition, and the use of sound effects?”

2. Speaking to Communicate

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose

- 2.1** communicate orally for several different purposes, using language appropriate for the intended audience (*e.g., participate in a small-group discussion in order to reach a consensus*⁸; *explain evacuation procedures to a new student; participate in a choral reading performed for another class; give specific and relevant examples from a recent field trip to inform fellow students who were absent; support and defend personal opinions in a class debate*⁹; *present an oral report summarizing the main ideas from a jigsaw activity*¹⁰)

Teacher prompts: “How might your recounting of a funny story be different when told to an audience of adults rather than an audience of your peers?” “How can you plan your presentation to make sure all of your audience members feel included and understand your key points when you are talking?”

Interpersonal Speaking Strategies

- 2.2** demonstrate an understanding of several different interpersonal speaking strategies and adapt them to suit the purpose, situation, and audience, exhibiting sensitivity to cultural differences (*e.g., use direct, strong, yet polite language and tone when registering a complaint with customer service about a faulty product*¹¹; *acknowledge others’ ideas before challenging their*

7. TL Media 7-10 “Evaluating the Effectiveness of Media Messages” 28 8. TLCC 7-12 “Group Roles” 158 9. TLCC 7-12 “Effective Presentation Skills” 196 10. TLCC 7-12 “Jigsaw” 170 11. TLCC 7-12 “Discussion Etiquette” 176

views;¹² avoid the use of personal, defamatory, and prejudicial comments; recognize and adhere to time limits and other constraints¹³)

Teacher prompts: “What is the most effective way to present your complaint about the product?” “How do you react when someone speaks to you in a loud voice? What techniques can you use to express an opposing opinion politely?”

Clarity and Coherence

2.3 communicate in a clear, coherent manner appropriate to the purpose, subject matter, and intended audience (e.g., *present an argument that has a clearly stated purpose, point-by-point development, and relevant supporting details; plan and produce a radio broadcast*;¹⁴ *rehearse appropriate responses to possible interview questions with a peer, and clarify responses after listening to the peer’s constructive criticism*)

Teacher prompts: “How does planning your presentation ahead of time help you present in an organized manner that is suitable for your purpose?”

Diction and Devices

2.4 use appropriate words, phrases, and terminology, and several different stylistic devices, to communicate their meaning and engage their intended audience (e.g., *use workplace terminology and specific details to report an accident to their manager in a role play; use appropriate language to tell a story about a personal experience on vacation*¹⁵)

Teacher prompt: “What specific words are used for effective communication in your workplace setting? How do you change the way you speak when you are dealing with customers or clients versus co-workers?”

Vocal Strategies

2.5 identify several different vocal strategies and use them selectively and with sensitivity to audience needs (e.g., *adjust tone and volume when presenting the “for” and “against” positions on using animals in research; use changes of pitch and pace to differentiate between characters in a story*¹⁶)

Teacher prompts: “How can you adapt the tone of your voice to invite others to contribute to a small-group discussion?” “How can you use changes in volume to add intensity or emphasize meaning in an oral presentation?”

Non-Verbal Cues

2.6 identify several different non-verbal cues and use them, with sensitivity to audience needs, to help convey their meaning (e.g., *make eye contact with the audience during a question-and-answer session or while sharing information*;¹⁷ *use role play to demonstrate appropriate body language for particular workplace situations, such as being interviewed for a job or dealing with an irate customer; use appropriate non-verbal cues to ask for assistance from the teacher*)

Teacher prompts: “How does maintaining eye contact with your audience affect their level of interest?” “What effect does physical proximity have on your listeners?”

Audio-Visual Aids

2.7 use several different audio-visual aids to support and enhance oral presentations (e.g., *use a video clip to support a discussion about images of gender; select three props or costume pieces to enhance a monologue; create an overhead to outline important ideas in an oral report; create a compilation of music to accompany a presentation*)

Teacher prompt: “How does this video clip help the speaker to communicate the message effectively?”

3. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

3.1 describe several different strategies they used before, during, and after listening and speaking; explain which ones they found most helpful; and identify several specific steps they can take to improve their oral communication skills (e.g., *explain how varying their speaking strategies in the future will improve their delivery; describe the preparation strategies they used before making an oral presentation and comment on the effectiveness of these strategies*)

12. TLCC 7-12 “Triangle Debate” 186 13. TLCC 7-12 “Effective Presentation Skills” 196 14. TL Media 7-10 “Producing a Public Announcement for the Radio” 33 15. TLCC 7-12 “Think/Pair/Share” 152 16. TLCC 7-12 “Effective Presentation Skills” 196 17. TLCC 7-12 “Effective Presentation Skills” 196

Teacher prompts: “How could this misunderstanding have been avoided through the use of listening skills? Would the outcome have been different if more thought had been given to word selection?” “What strategies do you use to make sure your message reaches a diverse audience?”

Interconnected Skills

3.2 identify a variety of their skills in viewing, representing, reading, and writing and explain how the skills help them improve their oral communication skills (*e.g., explain how creating media texts helps them organize an oral presentation; explain how viewing a film on workplace safety helps them prepare for an oral report on the topic*)

Teacher prompts: “How did writing an evaluation of a peer’s presentation help you to improve your own delivery?” “What strengths do you have as a reader that you could use to help you become a better listener?”

READING AND LITERATURE STUDIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- 1. Reading for Meaning:** read and demonstrate an understanding of a variety of informational, graphic, and literary texts, using a range of strategies to construct meaning;
- 2. Understanding Form and Style:** recognize a variety of text forms, text features, and stylistic elements and demonstrate understanding of how they help communicate meaning;
- 3. Reading With Fluency:** use knowledge of words and cueing systems to read fluently;
- 4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as readers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful before, during, and after reading.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

1. Reading for Meaning

By the end of this course, students will:

Variety of Texts

- 1.1** read several different short, contemporary, student- and teacher-selected texts that come from diverse cultures and reflect a variety of perspectives on current issues, identifying specific purposes for reading (*e.g., summarize the events in a narrative; research a product in a selection of fashion or automotive publications;¹ identify significant events in the life of a person from a country that you would like to learn more about, based on an online biography; summarize a range of opinions on a contemporary issue after reading three short texts of different forms that present differing perspectives on the issue²*)

Teacher prompt: “Review your list of the different texts you’ve read this semester. Which ones did you enjoy reading most? Why? What is it about a text that captures your interest or motivates you to read?”

Using Reading Comprehension Strategies

- 1.2** use several different reading comprehension strategies before, during, and after reading to understand both simple and complex texts (*e.g., skim an article to identify key points; collaborate with classmates to predict the conclusion of a short story; visualize and sketch*

the characters in a novel, then use a mind map to represent and track their relationships; make connections between the text and their own experiences, using a Rapid Writing strategy³)

Teacher prompts: “How does your visual image of the character compare with your partner’s? How do you account for the differences?” “What are the key points that you have discovered by skimming the article?” “What connections can you now see between the characters that you didn’t notice before completing the mind map?”

Demonstrating Understanding of Content

- 1.3** identify the important ideas and supporting details in both simple and complex texts (*e.g., summarize the key ideas from a newspaper article, using a “5 W’s and How” graphic organizer; summarize the events of the plot of a novel, using a fishbone organizer;⁴ compare opposing opinions in two letters to the editor, using a Venn diagram*)

Teacher prompts: “What are the main events that develop the plot of the novel?” “How would you summarize the main argument in each of the letters to the editor? List the evidence each writer provides to support his or her argument.”

1. TL Technological Education 9-12 “Reading Graphical and Informational Texts” 14, 20 2. TLE 10-12 “Venn Diagram” 96 3. TLCC 7-12 “Rapid Writing” 98 4. TLE 10-12 “Fishbone Organizer” 63

Making Inferences

- 1.4** make and explain inferences about both simple and complex texts, supporting their explanations with stated and implied ideas from the texts (*e.g., make a hypothesis about a company's safety practices based on evidence in a workplace incident report; identify the target market for a product based on evidence in a print advertisement*⁵)

Teacher prompts: "What can you conclude about the company's training program based on what you read in the workplace incident report?" "What particular features of this advertisement suggest its target market?"

Extending Understanding of Texts

- 1.5** extend understanding of both simple and complex texts by making connections between the ideas in them and personal knowledge, experience, and insights; other texts; and the world around them (*e.g., compare the experience of a teen in a story with their own experience; compare the values promoted in an advertisement with their own values; compare the ideas in other texts they have read on the same topic or theme*)

Teacher prompts: "What insights did you gain from this story that might lead you to act differently in a similar situation?" "What seems to be important to the characters represented in this ad? Are the same things important to you?" "What impact does the cultural, racial or faith identity of the individuals in the article have on your response to their situation?"

Analysing Texts

- 1.6** analyse texts in terms of the information, ideas, issues, or themes they explore, examining how various aspects of the texts contribute to the presentation or development of these elements (*e.g., explain how the theme of a short story becomes apparent as the plot of the story unfolds; explain how details, anecdotes, and examples are used to support the author's thesis in an article; explain how the detailed sequencing of steps helps to clarify a procedure; explain how the repetition of a phrase in a song reinforces the message of the song*)

Teacher prompts: "Explain how the conflict between the characters is used to illustrate the main theme of the story." "What moments in the story made you think this might happen?"

Evaluating Texts

- 1.7** evaluate the effectiveness of both simple and complex texts, using evidence from the text to support their opinions (*e.g., sort and classify information from a report to determine whether the evidence effectively supports the conclusions; determine whether they find the argument in an opinion piece effective, based on the facts and ideas presented in the piece and the way in which they are presented*)

Teacher prompts: "Did you find the author's conclusions in the report convincing? Why or why not?" "What do you think accounts for the impact of the argument in this opinion piece? Does it have to do with the building up of evidence, from the least significant to the most persuasive?"

Critical Literacy

- 1.8** identify the perspectives and/or biases evident in both simple and complex texts and comment on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, and identity (*e.g., describe the attitudes or values revealed in texts found on their favourite website; comment on the reliability of the narrator in a short story; review a workplace brochure, a promotional booklet from a local department store, or a mail-order catalogue for inclusivity*)

Teacher prompts: "Is there any evidence of bias in the protagonist's words? How might another character have told the story?" "What values and beliefs are evident in the brochure you are studying?" "Who are the people represented in this advertisement? Who is missing?"

2. Understanding Form and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

Text Forms

- 2.1** identify several different characteristics of informational, graphic, and literary text forms and explain how they help communicate meaning (*e.g., a supported opinion contains an opening, stated opinions, transitional words or phrases, supporting details, and a conclusion; an explanation of procedure outlines the sequence of steps or events and describes the goal of the procedure and the materials and methods used; television listings and bus schedules are organized in ways that communicate information most efficiently for the purpose*)

5. TLCC 7-12 "Reading Between the Lines (Inferences)" 40

Teacher prompts: “How would you find the exact time a bus would be expected at your stop on a given day?” “What differences can you identify in the organization of these two reports? Why do you think they are different?”

Text Features

2.2 identify several different text features and explain how they help communicate meaning (e.g., explain the function of columns, sidebars, and diagrams in newspaper and magazine articles; explain how navigational aids, such as drop-down menus, links, and icons, help a reader to find information on a website; explain how visual elements, such as borders, shading, italics, bullets, and numbered lists, improve the readability of a report)

Teacher prompts: “Why do you think this portion of the text is shaded?” “Explain how an index helps you locate information.” “What kinds of navigational aids are used on your favourite website?”

Elements of Style

2.3 identify several different elements of style in both simple and complex texts and explain how they help communicate meaning and enhance the effectiveness of the text (e.g., repetition may be used to create emphasis in a persuasive article; the choice of words can create a serious tone and a sense of urgency in a fire safety pamphlet; contrast and reversal may create tension or humour in a poem; colloquial language can convey important information about a character in a play, novel, or short story)

Teacher prompts: “Which words and phrases are repeated in the article? What effect does the repetition create? What are some other words the author could have used instead?” “What do you notice about this character’s language in the play? How is it different from the language used by other characters? Why did the author use a different style or level of language for this character?”

3. Reading With Fluency

By the end of this course, students will:

Reading Familiar Words

3.1 automatically understand most words in several different reading contexts (e.g., words from grade-level texts; words from texts chosen for shared, guided, and independent reading; terminology associated with contracts, reports, and workplace documents)

Teacher prompt: “What words in the report are familiar to you? Where else have you seen those words used? How can you use those words in another context?”

Reading Unfamiliar Words

3.2 use appropriate decoding strategies to read and understand unfamiliar words (e.g., check the sidebars for clues to the meaning of the word; locate the word in the glossary; find previous uses of the word in the text and try to grasp its meaning from the context; create a career-specific vocabulary list)

Teacher prompts: “What features in the text can help you to decode unfamiliar words? Which is more helpful – the sidebars or the glossary?” “How is this word related to the roots and prefixes we studied earlier?” “Does this word remind you of a word you know from another language?”

Developing Vocabulary

3.3 identify and use several different strategies to expand vocabulary, with an emphasis on recognizing synonyms and antonyms, and homophones and homonyms (e.g., keep a personal list of new words and phrases encountered in texts; use a dictionary and/or thesaurus to find more appropriate words for a specific context; identify familiar prefixes, suffixes, and root words in unfamiliar technical terminology; think of words and phrases to describe a friend and then use a thesaurus to locate synonyms)

Teacher prompts: “What is the difference between a homophone [there/their, bear/bare] and a homonym [rock music/rock wall]?” “Why is it important to know that some words sound the same but are spelled differently and mean different things? How can this information help you communicate more effectively?”

4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

4.1 describe several different strategies they used before, during, and after reading; explain which ones they found most helpful; and identify several specific steps they can take to improve as readers (e.g., use a Likert scale to rate their understanding and use of specific strategies;⁶ create a rough pie chart to show the relative frequency with which they use various

6. TLE 10-12 “Scales” 34

strategies; describe the similarities and differences in the way they read an incident report and a short story)

Teacher prompts: “How did previewing the vocabulary and talking about unfamiliar words affect your reading of the report?” “Explain to a peer how you used context clues in the story to figure out an unfamiliar word.” “What strategies do you use to remember what you read?”

Interconnected Skills

- 4.2** identify several of their skills in listening, speaking, writing, viewing, and representing and explain how the skills help them read more effectively (*e.g., write a journal entry*

explaining how viewing a film adapted from a novel affected their understanding of that novel)

Teacher prompts: “Did seeing the movie help you understand the plot and characters of the novel better, or in a different way?” “How does making summary notes about a story help to increase your understanding?” “How does creating a visual representation of the information in a text help you understand the information?”

WRITING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- 1. Developing and Organizing Content:** generate, gather, and organize ideas and information to write for an intended purpose and audience;
- 2. Using Knowledge of Form and Style:** draft and revise their writing, using a variety of informational, graphic, and literary forms and stylistic elements appropriate for the purpose and audience;
- 3. Applying Knowledge of Conventions:** use editing, proofreading, and publishing skills and strategies, and knowledge of language conventions, to correct errors, refine expression, and present their work effectively;
- 4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as writers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful at different stages in the writing process.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

1. Developing and Organizing Content

By the end of this course, students will:

Identifying Topic, Purpose, and Audience

- 1.1** identify the topic, purpose, and audience for several different types of writing tasks (e.g., *an opinion piece about an Aboriginal issue for a school or community newsletter; a brochure describing activities offered by their school for a student audience;¹ a letter of application for a job in a local company; a narrative about a personal experience for a class publication*)

Teacher prompt: “Is this brochure for students now attending this school, or for students who may be interested in attending it? How will your decision about the target audience affect the content of the brochure?”

Generating and Developing Ideas

- 1.2** generate and focus ideas for potential writing tasks, using several different strategies and print, electronic, and other resources, as appropriate (e.g., *ask themselves questions to identify their prior knowledge about the topic and the information they need; in small groups, use a graphic organizer to record and focus the ideas they generate for their topic;² conduct a class survey to gather opinions about a local issue they are considering as a topic, and record the opinions in a table or a chart for later review;*

search online library catalogues to identify potential sources of information; keep records of sources used and information gathered in a form that makes them easy to understand and retrieve, such as a T-chart)

Teacher prompt: “What writing ideas were generated by your group? How did you focus these ideas to decide on a particular topic?”

Research

- 1.3** locate and select information to support ideas for writing, using several different strategies and print, electronic, and other resources, as appropriate (e.g., *create a research plan and track their progress using a print template; identify several types of sources that are most likely to provide relevant information for their assignment, such as newspaper articles, multimedia resources, or interviews with community, neighbourhood, or family members; use key word searches and other browsing strategies when using search engines and Internet directories to locate specific information relevant to their topic; record all sources of information in a list of works cited or references, observing conventions for proper documentation and full acknowledgement of sources and extracts, in recognition of the need to credit original authors and promote academic honesty; use a checklist to evaluate sources and information for reliability, objectivity, and comprehensiveness*)

1. TLCC 7-12 “Writing an Explanation” 148 2. TLE 10-12 “PMI Place Mat” 116

Teacher prompts: “How have discussions with your peers and family about your research project helped you progress with it?” “What does *plagiarism* mean, and why do you think people plagiarize? Why is it wrong?”

Organizing Ideas

- 1.4** identify, sort, and order main ideas and supporting details for writing tasks, using several different strategies and organizational patterns suited to the content and the purpose for writing (e.g., *in small groups, cluster key ideas to develop an agenda for a meeting of the yearbook committee; use a storyboard to order elements chronologically for a comic strip*;³ *use a form such as a T-chart to list and to compare and contrast the qualities of two products, in preparation for writing a report recommending one of the products over the other*)

Teacher prompts: “What criteria are you using to determine the most important items for your agenda and the ‘supporting ideas’ that would be discussed under each item?” “What elements would you put on a labelled diagram to explain how a DVD player works?”

Reviewing Content

- 1.5** determine whether the ideas and information gathered are relevant to the topic, sufficient for the purpose, and meet the requirements of the writing task (e.g., *skim their notes to pinpoint the ideas and information most relevant to their topic, marking them with sticky notes, and then determine if any important information is missing*)

Teacher prompts: “Is your information complete, and does it represent all relevant perspectives? If not, what further research could you do to minimize gaps?” “What information from your survey of the summer job experiences of your peers will help you to design your résumé?”

2. Using Knowledge of Form and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

Form

- 2.1** write for different purposes and audiences, using several different informational, graphic, and literary forms (e.g., *a magazine article about a human interest story; a poem, based on the model of a poem studied in class; a supported opinion, in the form of a letter to the editor, about gender stereotyping in the media; an illustrated short story or poem for preschool children*)

Teacher prompt: “You’ve been asked to tell this human interest story in a magazine article. In what other forms have you encountered human interest stories? In what ways would a news report differ from a magazine article on the story?”

Voice

- 2.2** establish an identifiable voice in their writing, modifying language and tone to suit the form, audience, and purpose for writing (e.g., *use the appropriate level of language, including slang or jargon, to create a rap; use vivid descriptive language to create a particular mood or tone in a poem; use a businesslike tone and an appropriate level of language in a memo to staff about emergency evacuation procedures in case of a fire*)

Teacher prompt: “Pretend you are writing an advertisement. How can you make the voice distinctive, so that the ad will be memorable?”

Diction

- 2.3** use appropriate descriptive and evocative words, phrases, and expressions to make their writing clear and vivid for their intended audience (e.g., *describe a location in some detail; make a list of active verbs that could depict a character’s way of walking or talking, and choose the most evocative ones to use in a descriptive paragraph*⁴)

Teacher prompts: “Which of the descriptions in this piece of writing could be more vivid?” “How does a good description affect you? Can you visualize the scene, or feel the character’s emotions as a result of the description?”

Sentence Craft and Fluency

- 2.4** write complete sentences that communicate their meaning clearly and accurately, varying sentence type, structure, and length for different purposes and making logical transitions between ideas (e.g., *combine short sentences, where appropriate, to clarify meaning and improve flow; use transitional words to show the relationship between the ideas in two or more sentences*⁵)

Teacher prompt: “Are you using the same few transitional words over and over? Make a list of transitional words, and keep it handy for future reference.”

3. TLE 10-12 “Reading Different Text Forms” 36 4. TLE 10-12 “Sentence Starters” 46 5. TLE 10-12 “Revising and Editing: The Verb ‘To Be’” 56

Critical Literacy

2.5 explain how their own beliefs, values, and experiences are revealed in their writing (e.g., *examine their writing to check for bias and to determine whether their language and ideas are inclusive and non-discriminatory*;⁶ *write a script in which two characters hold different positions on a current issue in the news*; *explain in a personal essay their response to cultural expectations they have encountered in their work experiences*)

Teacher prompts: “How do you think the language you have used in this piece of writing reflects your values?” “What other points of view have you considered?” “Which of these two characters more closely reflects your own perspective on the subject?”

Revision

2.6 revise drafts to improve the content, organization, clarity, and style of their written work, using a variety of teacher-modelled strategies (e.g., *identify wording in their work that indicates a gender bias, and substitute gender-neutral language*; *identify sentences in a piece of writing that are out of place and reorganize to improve the flow of ideas*; *determine whether the repetition of a key word or phrase for emphasis would reinforce their argument and/or enhance the effectiveness of their text*)

Teacher prompts: “Have you varied the type and length of your sentences to make your writing more interesting for the reader?” “Does your writing tell your readers everything they need to know in order to understand your argument?” “How has your revision made your text clearer?”

Producing Drafts

2.7 produce revised draft pieces of both simple and complex texts written to meet criteria identified by the teacher, based on the curriculum expectations (e.g., *adequate development of information and ideas, logical organization, appropriate use of form and style, appropriate use of conventions*)

Teacher prompt: “Before you submit your revised set of instructions, check to ensure that no steps are missing.”

3. Applying Knowledge of Conventions

By the end of this course, students will:

Spelling

3.1 use knowledge of spelling rules and patterns, several different types of resources, and appropriate strategies to spell familiar and new words correctly (e.g., *apply spelling patterns such as “i before e except after c” appropriately*; *maintain lists of words learned from shared, guided, and independent reading texts to help them spell words correctly*; *check their spellings in available print and electronic resources*; *apply their knowledge of root words, prefixes, and suffixes to spell technical words correctly*)

Teacher prompt: “Did you use the spelling tool in your word-processing program to check the spellings in your text?”

Vocabulary

3.2 build vocabulary for writing by confirming word meaning(s) and reviewing word choice, using several different types of resources and strategies, as appropriate for the purpose (e.g., *refer to classroom word walls*;⁹ *consult a variety of print and online resources that are appropriate to their purpose, including glossaries, word banks, and technical dictionaries, to confirm meanings of words*; *maintain lists of technical words encountered in trade or professional publications, and determine how these words are formed from root words, prefixes, and suffixes*)¹⁰

Teacher prompt: “What other words or phrases would convey your meaning more clearly in this report?”

Punctuation

3.3 use punctuation correctly to communicate their intended meaning (e.g., *use quotation marks to set off words and phrases taken from sources*; *use punctuation that is appropriate to their purpose and to the form of their writing, including forms such as letters, memos, and notes*)

Teacher prompt: “Read your work aloud, pausing where you have used commas and periods, so that the group can help you determine if any punctuation is missing.”

Grammar

3.4 use grammar conventions correctly to communicate their meaning clearly (e.g., *write complete and correct simple, compound, complex, and compound-complex sentences*;¹¹ *consistently make verbs agree with subjects and pronouns agree with antecedents*)

6. TL Library 7-12 “Reacting to Reading: Critically Evaluating Resources” 18 7. TLCC 7-12 “Revising and Editing: Asking Questions to Revise Writing” 128 8. TLE 7-9 “Sample Roots and Prefixes” 54 9. TLCC 7-12 “Creating a Word Wall” 30 10. TLE 7-9 “Sample Roots and Prefixes” 54 11. TLE 10-12 “Modelled Writing” 51

Teacher prompt: “Could you combine these short sentences to make a more interesting longer sentence? Which connecting words would you use? Does the punctuation need to be changed?”

Proofreading

- 3.5** proofread and correct their writing, using guidelines developed with the teacher and peers (*e.g., review drafts using an editing checklist specific to the writing task; use a highlighter to identify questionable words or phrases that they need to check for correct usage*¹²)

Teacher prompt: “What words did you highlight as possible errors when you reread the piece? Have you checked those words to confirm their meaning and their spelling?”

Publishing

- 3.6** use several different presentation features, including print and script, fonts, graphics, and layout, to improve the clarity and coherence of their written work and to engage their audience (*e.g., select the most appropriate fonts, graphics, and layout for a brochure, keeping their purpose and audience in mind; make the appropriate changes to adapt an electronic template for a facsimile to one for a memo*)

Teacher prompt: “What visual will you use as your centre of interest? Where could you place it? How would you arrange text around it?”

Producing Finished Works

- 3.7** produce pieces of published work to meet criteria identified by the teacher, based on the curriculum expectations (*e.g., adequate development of information and ideas, logical organization, appropriate use of form and style, appropriate use of conventions*)

Teacher prompt: “What important points have you learned about creating a brochure? What are some important considerations you could include on a checklist for brochures that you could review before submitting your finished work?”

4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

- 4.1** describe several different strategies they used before, during, and after writing; explain which ones they found most helpful; and identify several specific steps they can take to improve as writers (*e.g., describe how brainstorming in a small group helped them generate ideas for writing; describe specific ways in which reading a piece of writing aloud to a partner for feedback helped them to improve it*)

Teacher prompts: “What strategy for generating ideas would be worth trying again?” “Describe a problem you encountered while working on this assignment, and how you resolved it.” “What would you do differently if you had the opportunity to redo this assignment?”

Interconnected Skills

- 4.2** identify several different skills they have in listening, speaking, reading, viewing, and representing, and explain how these skills help them write more effectively (*e.g., describe how listening to the lyrics of a particular song has improved their ability to write and/or enriched their writing*)

Teacher prompt: “How did listening closely to the way teenagers talk to one another after school help you write the dialogue for your scene?”

Portfolio

- 4.3** select several examples of different types of writing that they think most clearly reflect their growth and competence as writers, and explain the reasons for their choice (*e.g., select a piece of writing for a class anthology and explain why they think it is a good example of their work; choose several pieces for a literacy portfolio that reflect their growth over time, explaining how each one demonstrates an improvement in their writing skills*)

Teacher prompt: “Which pieces of your writing best reflect your writing skills? Why did you choose these pieces?”

MEDIA STUDIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- 1. Understanding Media Texts:** demonstrate an understanding of a variety of media texts;
- 2. Understanding Media Forms, Conventions, and Techniques:** identify some media forms and explain how the conventions and techniques associated with them are used to create meaning;
- 3. Creating Media Texts:** create a variety of media texts for different purposes and audiences, using appropriate forms, conventions, and techniques;
- 4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as media interpreters and creators, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful in understanding and creating media texts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

1. Understanding Media Texts

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose and Audience

- 1.1** explain how both simple and complex media texts are created to suit particular purposes and audiences (*e.g., documentaries are made for an audience that expects them to be factual and accurate, and they use on-location footage and interviews with experts to support their authenticity*¹)

Teacher prompts: “How would you characterize the audience for an afternoon radio call-in show? A late-night jazz program?” “Why do television ‘infotainment’ show hosts give previews of upcoming items in the program?”

Interpreting Messages

- 1.2** interpret simple and complex media texts, identifying and explaining the overt and implied messages they convey (*e.g., images of models and uncrowded beaches in travel brochures create specific impressions of the destinations;² the use of a “movie trailer” format in advertisements for video games encourages players to expect excitement and drama from the games*)

Teacher prompt: “How do car, truck, and motorcycle brochures use photographs, written text, fonts, and colour to create favourable impressions of their products?”

Evaluating Texts

- 1.3** evaluate how effectively information, ideas, issues, and opinions are communicated in both simple and complex media texts and decide whether the texts achieve their intended purpose (*e.g., determine how well a television sitcom communicates messages about accepting or accommodating diversity; determine how appropriate an endorsement by a specific celebrity is for a particular product*³)

Teacher prompt: “How well do the signs in this [supermarket/library/big-box store/mall] communicate what customers need to know? How could they be improved to serve customers of diverse ages, cultures, and abilities as well as possible?”

Audience Responses

- 1.4** identify and explain different audience responses to selected media texts (*e.g., suggest reasons why feature films are rated acceptable for different audiences by the Ontario Film Review Board; suggest reasons why an adult and a teenager might respond differently to a video game*)

Teacher prompt: “Why might you, your parents, and your teachers disagree about the age classification on a video game?”

1. TL Media 7-10 “Exploring the Key Concepts of Media Literacy” 2 2. TL Media 7-10 “Reading Between the Lines (Predictions)” 10
3. TL Media 7-10 “Evaluating the Effectiveness of Media Messages” 28

Critical Literacy

- 1.5** identify the perspectives and/or biases evident in both simple and complex media texts, and comment on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, and identity (e.g., *identify the values suggested by depictions of destinations in travel brochures and on websites; describe common features of portrayals of Aboriginal peoples in Canadian media and the impression they create*)

Teacher prompts: “Why do you think these travel brochures depict the local residents in ‘exotic’ clothing or situations? What is the intended effect on potential customers?” “What pictures might have been deliberately left out of these brochures, and why?” “What insights did you gain about Aboriginal peoples from this film by an Aboriginal filmmaker? How did portrayals in it differ from depictions you’ve seen in news reports and the popular media?”

Production Perspectives

- 1.6** explain how several different production, marketing, and distribution factors influence the media industry (e.g., *identify and explain factors that influence decisions about which movies will be made, including factors such as the potential for product placements and/or profitable “spin-offs” like toys or fashions*)

Teacher prompt: “Can you give some examples of the use of ‘product placement’ in television shows? What is its purpose?”

2. Understanding Media Forms, Conventions, and Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

Form

- 2.1** identify general characteristics of several different media forms and explain how they shape content and create meaning (e.g., *radio dramas use sound effects to create mental pictures for listeners; photographs of food in advertising use visual signals – of steam rising, cheese melting, and so on – to suggest taste sensations to viewers;⁴ music videos use images and various film and editing techniques to present visual interpretations of popular songs*)

Teacher prompts: “Why do you think the film version of a story left out particular scenes and/or details that were in the book?” “Do the visual elements in this music video emphasize a particular aspect of the song, or represent a particular interpretation of the

lyrics? Does the interpretation of the song in the video differ from your own interpretation of it? In what way?”

Conventions and Techniques

- 2.2** identify several different conventions and/or techniques used in familiar media forms and explain how they convey meaning and influence their audience (e.g., *movie ads in newspapers and DVD covers cite reviewers’ quotes, star ratings, and Oscar nominations to convince potential customers a movie is worth seeing; framing, camera angle, lighting, and editing are techniques used in filmmaking to convey meaning and create mood*)

Teacher prompts: “Why does a newspaper start several stories on the front page and continue them on inside pages?” “How do the advertisements in a newspaper relate to the content of a particular section?” “What effect did the fast-paced music and editing have in this scene of the movie?”

3. Creating Media Texts

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose and Audience

- 3.1** describe the topic, purpose, and audience for media texts they plan to create (e.g., *a poster to caution workers about the need for safe storage and handling of hazardous materials*), and identify specific challenges they may face in achieving their purpose

Teacher prompt: “What kind of ad campaign might help persuade jobless young people to seek training to acquire marketable skills?”

Form

- 3.2** select a media form to suit the topic, purpose, and audience for a media text they plan to create and explain why it is an appropriate choice (e.g., *explain why a poster would be a good way to inform students about safety procedures to be followed in the science lab; explain why an e-zine is a good way to publicize and celebrate the work of student writers, photographers, and illustrators*)

Teacher prompt: “What media form might be most effective for a presentation on workplace safety?”

Conventions and Techniques

- 3.3** identify several different conventions and/or techniques appropriate to a media form they plan to use, and explain how these will help communicate meaning (*e.g., conventions/techniques for a music CD cover: a photo featuring the musician(s) that evokes a mood or shows a setting related to the title piece or theme of the CD*)

Teacher prompt: “What standard elements would you need to include in the packaging for a Canadian energy bar? Why are they important?”

Producing Media Texts

- 3.4** produce media texts for several different purposes and audiences, using appropriate forms, conventions, and techniques (*e.g., a short workplace video on a technical topic⁵*)

Teacher prompt: “What type of media text could you create to commemorate an important event in your family? What elements would you include in your display to commemorate your family’s history?”

identify several specific steps they can take to improve as media interpreters and producers (*e.g., explain how the ability to identify and interpret implicit messages in media texts helps them detect media manipulation in everyday situations*)

Teacher prompt: “What skills or strategies do you find most useful before, during, and after viewing a media text? Are there other skills or strategies you don’t use regularly that might be helpful in future?”

Interconnected Skills

- 4.2** explain how their skills in listening, speaking, reading, and writing help them interpret and produce media texts (*e.g., the ability to vary their tone and pace in an oral presentation to hold the attention of the audience can help them produce a compelling podcast*)

Teacher prompt: “How does participating in a discussion about a topic help you focus your ideas for a media production about the topic?”

4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

- 4.1** describe several different strategies they used in interpreting and creating media texts, explain which ones they found most helpful, and